

ENG516 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG516) Teaching of Business Communication

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson 01

ESSENTIALS OF BUSINESS ENGLISH AND BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

Topic - 001: What is Business Communication?

What is the definition of Business Communication?

Business Communication is the communication that occurs in the workplace, corporate offices, or educational settings and is primarily conducted in the English language.

Why is effective business communication important in the modern workplace?

Effective business communication is crucial for success in the modern workplace, as it involves both internal and external communication, often on a global scale, for purposes such as selling, persuading, negotiating, informing, and presenting.

How has the teaching of business English evolved in recent decades?

The teaching of business English has gained significance over the last few decades, with a growing number of undergraduates from various fields needing to take courses in business English communication.

What distinguishes business English from general English, and why is some knowledge of general English necessary for learning business English?

Business English builds upon general English and focuses on business-specific situations, emphasizing clarity, logic, and presentation styles. A basic knowledge of general English is considered a prerequisite for learning business English.

Topic - 002: Origin of Business Communication

What are the key factors that contributed to the growth of business English teaching?

The growth of business English teaching was influenced by the importance of commerce and technology, the widespread use of English as an international language, and the oil crisis of the 1970s, which led to a need for cost-effective English language courses.

How did changes in linguistics impact the development of ESP and business English?

Linguistics shifted from describing the formal aspects of language to focusing on how language is used in real-life communication. This change emphasized the differences between written and spoken language and the language needs of specific groups.

How did developments in educational psychology influence the rise of ESP and business English?

Educational psychology emphasized the importance of considering learners' needs, interests, and motivation in language learning. This approach led to the development of courses that catered to learners' specific requirements.

Topic - 003: Scope of Business Communication

What are the main components of a Business English course?

A Business English course typically consists of language knowledge (grammar, vocabulary, and sound system) and communication skills (oral and written communication in business contexts).

How does business English differ from general English in terms of context and content?

Business English builds upon general English, focusing on business situations that require clarity, logic, and specific presentation styles. It also includes professional content, management skills, and cultural awareness.

What is the legitimate scope of business English teachers?

Business English teachers are responsible for designing and delivering courses that aim to enhance language knowledge, communication skills, management skills, cultural awareness, and the understanding of professional contexts.

Topic - 004: Development of Business Communication

What are the five main phases in the development of English for Specific Purposes (ESP)?

The five main phases in the development of ESP are Register Analysis, Rhetorical or Discourse Analysis, Target Situation Analysis/Needs Analysis, Skills and Strategies, and Learner-centered Approaches.

How did these phases contribute to the development of ESP, including business communication?

These phases contributed to ESP by shifting the focus from formal language aspects to discourse, identifying organizational patterns in texts, analyzing learner needs, exploring thinking processes underlying language use, and emphasizing learner-centered approaches.

Topic - 005: Important Terms in Business Communication and ESP

What is the ESP tree, and how does it categorize various branches of English language teaching?

The ESP tree categorizes various branches of English language teaching, such as English for Science and Technology, English for Business and Economics, and English for Social Sciences, under the umbrella of English for Specific Purposes (ESP).

What are the distinctions between English for Academic Purposes (EAP) and English for Vocational Purposes (EVP)?

EAP focuses on academic language needs, while EVP centers on language requirements for vocational purposes, which include work-related and professional contexts.

What are some specific terms related to business communication, such as ESBP and EGBP?

ESBP stands for English for Specific Business Purpose, while EGBP stands for English for General Business Purposes, targeting learners with limited working experience.

Topic - 006: Approach not Product

What is Business Communication teaching considered, and why?

Business Communication teaching is considered an approach rather than a product, as it emphasizes the learner's specific needs and is not a distinct form of language.

What distinguishes Business Communication teaching from other forms of language teaching?

Business Communication teaching is not different in kind from other language teaching; it uses common language learning processes and methodologies. It is distinguished by its focus on the learner's specific reasons for learning a foreign language.

What is the primary driving force behind Business Communication teaching?

The primary driving force behind Business Communication teaching, like all ESP teaching, is the learner's reason for learning a language, which guides all decisions regarding content and methods.

Lesson 02

ESSENTIALS OF BUSINESS ENGLISH AND BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

Topic 007: The Business English Learner

What are the key purposes of using English in the business world?

English is used for cooperation, negotiation, conflict resolution, persuasion, understanding, and more in business.

How can Business English learners be categorized based on their experience?

Business English learners can be categorized as pre-experienced, job-experienced, or general business-experienced.

How does a learner's level in a company's hierarchy affect their approach to Business English learning?

Senior managers may focus on specific skills, while juniors may not have specific needs.

Why might learners need to be grouped according to their national culture in language schools?

Different cultures have different traditions and values, so separate classes may be needed to avoid interference with learning.

What factors can determine a learner's specific needs in Business English?

Learners' specific needs can be determined by their job roles, such as secretaries, accountants, or technicians.

Why might learners be grouped based on their language proficiency?

Learners are grouped by language level, like beginners or advanced, based on their proficiency.

How can Business English learners be categorized based on their experience levels?

Business English learners can be categorized into three main groups based on their experience levels. First, there are pre-experienced learners, typically university or secondary school students, who have little or no real-world business experience and need guidance from the teacher to understand the business world. Second, job-experienced learners already have extensive knowledge of their jobs and specific needs for Business English courses. They do not require as much assistance in understanding the business context. Finally, general business-experienced learners fall between these two categories, possessing some job experience but learning English to transition into a new role or for specific purposes.

Topic 008: The Teaching Context

What types of educational institutes typically teach Business Communication?

Young adults are often taught Business Communication in schools, universities, and apprenticeship programs.

How does teaching in an educational institute differ from teaching in a private language school or in a company?

Educational institutes have larger classes and may focus less on specific target needs, while in-company teaching offers a more tailored experience.

What is a common teaching arrangement for Business English?

One-to-one (1-to-1) private lessons are a common arrangement in Business English teaching.

What are the key features of the teaching context for Business English in an educational institute?

In an educational institute, Business English classes cater to young adults. Teachers are expected to prepare students for written assignments, focusing on grading criteria and assessment requirements. These classes have diverse

language levels and skills, with students from various academic backgrounds. While students often have expectations about the teacher's expertise in the business world, they may not always prioritize English learning. The advantage of educational institutions is the flexibility to cover a wide range of topics, but it can be challenging to address specific target needs due to students' uncertain future English usage.

Topic 009: The Business English Teacher

How is the role of a Business English teacher different from that of a trainer, coach, or consultant?

A teacher educates, a trainer changes behavior for specific jobs, a coach helps learners in their working environment, and a consultant provides expertise and advice.

How does the role of a Business English teacher differ from traditional teaching?

The role of a Business English teacher differs from traditional teaching in that it often involves being a trainer, coach, or consultant. A teacher in the business context is expected to educate learners to enhance their chances of success in their careers. In contrast, a trainer is focused on changing a person's behavior or abilities to perform specific job-related tasks. Coaching involves helping learners utilize learning opportunities in their work environment by understanding their strengths and weaknesses. A consultant is an expert brought in for specific skills or know-how, such as analyzing communication needs. Business English teachers must adapt to their teaching context and be willing to learn.

Topic 010: Language in Context

What is the distinction between everyday English and Business English?

Business English is everyday English used within a business context.

Why is specialist language important in various professions, including business?

Specialist language is used to enhance communication and efficiency within specific professional groups.

How is Business English different from general English or English for Specific Purposes (ESP)?

Business English is a mix of general English, general Business English, and ESP, tailored to business contexts and objectives.

What distinguishes Business English from everyday English?

Business English is distinguished from everyday English by its context of use. When people use English in a business context, it becomes Business English. This language is used for various purposes in business, such as negotiating, buying, selling, and explaining, and it encompasses a wide range of communication skills. Furthermore, Business English includes specialized vocabulary used by professionals within specific industries, making it distinct from general or everyday English. Business English also incorporates language used in international business, which may differ from the English spoken by native speakers and is considered a lingua franca, evolving to meet the needs of its users.

Topic 011: Teaching Business English

Why has there been a growing awareness of the need for teaching Business Communication?

Increased trade, globalization, technology, and internationalization of education have highlighted the importance of teaching Business Communication.

What is the shift in approach from linguistic-centered teaching to a learner-centered approach?

The shift is towards teaching language in real-life contexts, focusing on learner-centered approaches.

What are the key components of communicative competence that Business English teachers need to focus on?

Business English teachers should focus on linguistic competence, discourse competence, and intercultural competence.

What has driven the growing awareness of the need to teach Business Communication?

Several factors have contributed to the growing awareness of the need to teach Business Communication. Increased trade and commerce activities, globalization, advancements in information and communication technology, internationalization

of education, and the recognition of English as a global lingua franca have all played a role. Significant political events, such as the aftermath of World War II, the Gulf War, and the end of the Cold War, have also accelerated this awareness. These factors have prompted a shift from traditional linguistic approaches to a learner-centered approach, where language teaching aims to facilitate real communication in real-life situations. Business English teachers now focus on three key components: linguistic competence, discourse competence, and intercultural competence.

Topic 012: Rationale of the Course

Why are Business Communication courses compulsory in many universities?

These courses are mandatory due to increased trade and commerce activities, globalization, and the acceptance of English as a lingua franca.

What are some common issues with teaching Business Communication in universities?

Courses often emphasize theoretical aspects, use irrelevant materials, and suffer from low student motivation.

How do undergraduates typically view Business Communication courses?

They often view it as a secondary subject, less relevant than their core courses.

What are some common challenges in teaching Business Communication courses at universities?

Teaching Business Communication courses in universities often comes with challenges. These courses are typically compulsory and are taught to students from various disciplines. The emphasis is often placed on theoretical aspects, neglecting practical language use in real-life situations. Large class sizes and students with varying backgrounds and abilities can make it difficult to meet specific target needs. Additionally, students may lack motivation as they do not see the immediate relevance of the content to their core subjects. The use of generic course materials not tailored to local contexts can hinder effective teaching. In many cases, students may prioritize their core courses over Business Communication, viewing it as less relevant to their overall academic goals.

Lesson 03

TEACHING OF BUSINESS COMMUNICATION-I

Topic 013: Linguistic Competence

What are the key components of communicative competence that business English teachers need to focus on?

Business English teachers need to focus on linguistic competence, discourse competence, and intercultural competence.

How is linguistic competence demonstrated in language use?

Linguistic competence is demonstrated in the use of basic language elements like vocabulary, grammar, and phonology.

What are the three types of words in the English language?

Words can be divided into lexical (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs), functional words (determiners, pronouns, modals, prepositions, coordinators), and inserts (e.g., yeah, well, ouch).

Explain the concept of collocations in language.

Collocations are words that often appear together due to their natural linguistic pairing, such as "small print" or "black and white."

What does colligation refer to in linguistic competence?

Colligation refers to how words occur in particular grammatical patterns, such as "letter of application" or "letter of complaint."

What are the different types of words, and how do they contribute to linguistic competence?

Words can be categorized into various types, including lexical words (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs), functional words (determiners, pronouns, modals, prepositions, coordinators), inserts (words like "yeah," "well," "ouch"), multi-words, phrasal words, collocations, idioms, and colligations. These categories play

a significant role in understanding and using language effectively in a business context.

Topic 014: Discourse Competence

How does discourse competence differ from linguistic competence?

Discourse competence focuses on language in use within context, while linguistic competence focuses on language elements out of context.

What is conversation analysis, and how does it relate to discourse competence?

Conversation analysis is a sociological approach used to analyze how people interact with each other in talk, which is important for understanding discourse competence.

Why is it essential for business communication learners to understand various discourse situations?

Learners need to understand different discourse situations to effectively communicate in various contexts within the business world.

Topic 015: Intercultural Competence

Why is intercultural competence important in business communication?

In the globalized world, business communicators need to be culturally sensitive when dealing with multinational companies and diverse cultural backgrounds.

What are some factors that influence culture?

Culture is influenced by factors like environment, society, gender, family, age, and ethics, among others.

What does the iceberg model illustrate in terms of culture?

The iceberg model shows that much of culture is hidden and not immediately visible, which can lead to misunderstandings if not recognized.

Topic 016: Approaches to Teaching English

What is the grammar translation method, and what is its focus?

The grammar translation method focuses on teaching languages through written texts, grammar, vocabulary, and cultural aspects, with an emphasis on listening and writing.

What is the behaviorist philosophy of language learning?

The behaviorist philosophy sees language learning as habit formation through repetition and conditioned responses.

Topic 017: Communicative Language Teaching

What is communicative language teaching (CLT), and what are its key principles?

CLT emphasizes using language for communication, viewing language as functions and focusing on real-life situations and meaning over form.

What is the primary difference between the weak and strong forms of CLT?

The weak form focuses on what is to be learned, while the strong form emphasizes how learning takes place through communication.

What are some variations of CLT, and how do they differ in their approaches to language learning?

CLT can be weak or strong. The weak form often follows a presentation-practice-production (PPP) approach, while the strong form emphasizes language learning through negotiation of meaning in real communication. Different CLT approaches suit different teaching styles and contexts.

Topic 018: Task-based Learning

What is the primary goal of task-based learning?

Task-based learning aims to engage learners in authentic, practical language use for meaningful purposes by completing tasks.

Why is task-based learning suitable for Business English learners?

Task-based learning allows learners to use immediately relevant language in real communication, similar to the business world.

Lesson 04

TEACHING OF BUSINESS COMMUNICATION-II

Topic 019: Dealing with Professional Content – the Contentious Issue/Organization in Business

What is a contentious issue in teaching Business Communication?

The contentious issue is the balance between language-focused and business-focused content.

What is the primary focus of language teachers in Business Communication?

The primary focus is language teaching, with business content providing a backdrop.

What role does the Business Communication teacher play in teaching business content?

The teacher needs to be a knowledgeable generalist about different types of organizations and business functions.

Topic 020: Evolution of Management/Division of Labor

Name the three management approaches discussed in the lesson.

The three management approaches are Scientific Management, Classical Organization Theory, and Behavioral Movement.

What is the focus of Scientific Management according to Taylor?

Taylor's focus is on scientific selection of workers, education, and friendly relations between workers and management.

What does Henri Fayol's Classical Organization Theory emphasize?

Fayol emphasizes managerial behavior and divides business operations into functional areas.

Name and briefly describe the three management approaches mentioned in the lesson.

Answer:

- **Scientific Management:** This approach, attributed to Taylor, emphasizes scientific selection of workers, education, and friendly worker-management relations.
- **Classical Organization Theory (Henri Fayol):** Fayol's approach recognizes the human factor in management and focuses on planning, organizing, commanding, coordinating, and controlling in business operations.
- **Behavioral Movement:** This approach addresses human behavior in the workplace, incorporating insights from psychology and sociology to create a more people-oriented management style.

Topic 021: Key Issues in Management/Business Sectors

Name some key areas in business sectors discussed in the lesson.

Some key areas include General Management, Administration, Customer Service, Finance, and Marketing.

Why is it important for Business Communication teachers to know about business organizations and sectors?

It helps in understanding learners' needs and designing relevant courses.

What are some key areas and departments within business organizations that Business Communication teachers should be familiar with?

Business Communication teachers should be familiar with General Management, Administration, Customer Service, Distribution, Finance, Legal, Personnel, Production, Marketing, Purchasing, Research and Development, and Sales.

Topic 022: Language of Business: Grammar, Vocabulary

What does grammar refer to in language?

Grammar refers to the rules and conventions of a language shared by native speakers.

What types of vocabulary are mentioned in Business English?

Specialized vocabulary includes Specialist-Specialist, Specialist-Non-specialist, Non-specialist-Specialist, and Generalist-Generalist.

Topic 023: Communication Skills in Business: Accuracy, Fluency, and Effectiveness

What are the three main objectives of Business Communication discussed in the lesson?

The objectives are accuracy, fluency, and effectiveness.

How is fluency different from accuracy in communication?

Fluency is a continuum ranging from zero competence to native-like competence, while accuracy is a binary concept of right or wrong.

Topic 024: Communication Skills in Management: Leadership, Team Building, Delegation

What are the three key aspects of leadership according to the lesson?

Leadership, according to the lesson, involves delegation, communication, and motivation of subordinates.

Why is effective communication important in team building?

Effective communication is central to achieving the commitment of team members, defining the mission, sharing decision-making, and running participatory staff meetings.

Lesson 05

NEEDS ANALYSIS-I

Topic - 025: What are Needs? What are Target Needs?

What distinguishes Business English (BE) from General English (GE) courses?

Business English aims to fulfill the needs of business and management students.

What is the primary goal of a needs analysis in Business English?

The goal is to collect information about the current and target situations for students.

In what order do the stages of Business Communication course development typically occur?

Needs analysis, curriculum design, materials selection, methodology, assessment, and evaluation.

Why is understanding the needs of Business English learners crucial for course objectives?

Business English learners have more precisely defined needs than general English learners, and these needs should shape the course objectives.

What are the three separate but linked elements of the needs analysis stage?

Answer:

- The range of communication and language required in the learner's present or future profession.
- The current ability of the learner in terms of language and communication.
- The actual objective of the training program.

Topic - 026: Current and Target Situation – The Gap

What is the primary purpose of a needs analysis in terms of the current and target situation?

To identify the training gap, which is the difference between where students are currently and where they want to be at the end of the teaching.

What is the distinction between learners' perceived needs and felt needs?

Perceived needs are the views of stakeholders like teachers, sponsors, and co-workers, while felt needs represent the learners' perspective.

How does the understanding of "needs" affect course design in ESP?

It helps in creating a focused course that caters to the most relevant areas for the learners or the company.

Topic - 027: Learning Needs

How does Hutchinson define the primary goal of a needs analysis in language teaching?

The goal is to provide what the learner lacks.

What are the key elements to consider when analyzing learning needs in Business English?

Answer:

- The learner's current communicative competence.
- Learner's wants and needs, which may differ from course designers' and sponsors' perceptions.

Topic - 028: Necessities, Lacks, Wants

What are "necessities" in a needs analysis, and how are they determined?

Necessities are the needs determined by the demands of the target situation, and they are identified by observing the target situation.

What is meant by "lacks" in a needs analysis?

Lacks refer to the gap between the target proficiency needed and the existing proficiency of the learners.

How do learners' "wants" fit into the needs analysis process?

Learners have their own views on what they want, which might differ from what course designers, sponsors, or teachers perceive as necessities.

Topic - 029: Analyzing Learning Needs

What tools can be used to collect information for analyzing learning needs?

Forms, questionnaires, interviews, observation, and tests can be used to gather data for needs analysis.

How does a needs analysis differentiate a General English course from an ESP course?

It justifies the content and focus of the ESP course and allows for modifications as the course progresses.

Topic - 030: Uniqueness of Learning Situation

Why is a needs analysis unique to a specific training situation?

Each training context is different, so there is no single, standard approach to conducting a needs analysis.

What ethical considerations should teachers keep in mind during a needs analysis?

Teachers should consider issues like confidentiality, consent, and the potential impact on learners' careers.

How does a needs analysis contribute to course development in a cyclic fashion?

The components of the needs analysis inform the entire course development process, with an ongoing and flexible nature.

Working on the Next Lessons

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